

Caravel

The speedy **SAILING SHIP** that harnessed wind power to rule the waves

Lateen sails allowed the ship to “tack”—sail in zigzags into the wind.

Not much room for cargo—caravels were designed for exploration.

How it changed

European explorers used caravels to sail farther than ever before, discovering new lands and opening up new trade routes.

the world

Exploring the world
Ships with sails had been around for thousands of years, but caravels were the first to truly **master the seas**. Developed in the 1400s, they were light and fast, with lateen sails (triangular sails fixed to a sloping yardarm) that made them **easier to maneuver** than previous sailing ships. Caravels could sail **LONG DISTANCES**, opening up new possibilities for intrepid explorers.

Henry the Navigator

The caravel was invented by Prince Henry of Portugal, known as Henry the Navigator, who founded a famous **NAVIGATION SCHOOL**. But, despite his name, Henry never went on a voyage of discovery in one of his ships—in fact, he **never went to sea at all**.



Setting sail

Caravels were invented just in time for **Christopher Columbus**—he sailed them across the Atlantic to the Caribbean in 1492. Not long after, **EUROPEAN EXPLORERS** colonized the Americas, India, and Africa, and opened up new **trade routes**, changing the lives of many of the people who lived there.

